

Most sensory advice assumes everyone is the same. Fill this in for you — and note that it can change day to day.

Where I sit, by sense

LEFT = I AVOID IT • RIGHT = I SEEK IT OUT

AVOID ← → SEEK

Sound	○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Light	○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Touch	○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Smell	○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Taste	○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Movement	○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Temperature	○ ○ ○ ○ ○
Crowds	○ ○ ○ ○ ○

My hard no's

THE ONES THAT END A DAY EARLY

What reliably helps me regulate

In my kit / on my person

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Ear defenders or loops | ☐ Sunglasses / cap |
| ☐ A stim object | ☐ Familiar snack |
| ☐ Water | ☐ _____ |

Knowing this isn't fussiness. It's a maintenance manual.

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Written to be handed over. Fill in the blanks, or leave it as it is — most of it is true for a lot of us.

When I tell you I'm autistic or ADHD

PLEASE DON'T SAY	TRY INSTEAD
"You don't seem autistic."	"Thanks for telling me."
"Everyone's a bit like that."	"What's it like for you?"
"Have you tried yoga / a diet?"	"Is there anything that would help?"
"But you're doing so well!"	"That must take a lot of effort."
"Isn't everyone on the spectrum?"	"I'll read up on it myself."

In everyday life, it helps if you

- ☐ Send it in writing, not just say it
- ☐ Ask before touching me
- ☐ Let me leave early without a fuss
- ☐ Give notice before plans change
- ☐ Say what you mean, plainly
- ☐ Don't take flat tone personally

If I go quiet or shut down

Stop talking. Turn the noise and lights down.

Don't ask questions — I can't answer them yet.

Stay nearby but don't crowd me.

Don't try to fix it. It passes.

The specific thing I'd most like you to know

You don't have to understand it all. You just have to believe me.

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Fill this in beforehand and take it with you. Handing someone a piece of paper is a completely valid way to communicate.

WHO I'M SEEING

DATE AND TIME

The main thing I need from this

IF ONLY ONE THING GETS COVERED, THIS IS IT

What's been happening

DATES, FREQUENCY, WHAT CHANGED

Questions I want to ask

What helps me in appointments

☐ Written instructions, not verbal

☐ Time to think before answering

☐ Warn me before any touch

☐ I may not make eye contact

☐ Plain language, no jargon

☐ Someone with me

Afterwards — what was actually said

WRITE IT DOWN BEFORE IT EVAPORATES